



THE VAULT

Approaching an Agency

The first email, and the principles behind opening a door quietly

THE PRIVATE CONCIERGE ACADEMY

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How this world actually hires

Households of this standing rarely advertise. They ask a consultant they already trust, or they ask someone the family already knows. Which means the specialist agencies are not a formality to be endured: for most careers, they are the door. A consultant who believes in you will put your name forward for years, to people you will never be able to reach yourself.

So you are not applying to an agency. You are beginning a professional relationship with someone whose entire business is their judgement of people. Behave accordingly, and behave that way for a long time.

Four principles

Register with several, and treat none of them casually. Five or six serious agencies, chosen for the regions and the roles you actually want.

Be findable, and be consistent. Your CV, your letter and your public presence must tell the same story. A consultant will look, and a contradiction is a rejection.

Never chase. One follow-up, ten days later, courteous and brief. Then leave them in peace and let your name work. Pressure reads as need, and need is the one thing this world will not hire.

Answer instantly, always. When a consultant finally writes, the speed and grace of your reply is the audition. Most candidates lose the role here, before anyone has met them.

The first email

Short. Specific. Free of need. It should read as though you are already someone, quietly looking for the right house.

Subject: Private Concierge / Lifestyle Manager, Geneva, fully mobile (Claire Duval)

Dear Ms Lawrence,

I am a private concierge, based in Geneva and fully mobile, and I would like to register with you.

For the past three years I have run the personal affairs of a UHNW family across four residences: their vendors, their household budgets, their journeys, and two major house projects delivered without disruption to the family. Before that, three seasons in guest relations for private chalets and villas, and two years as a concierge in a Paris palace hotel.

I am seeking a private household, in Europe or further, where discretion and anticipation are truly valued rather than merely mentioned. My CV is attached. References are available with the consent of the household.

I would be glad to speak whenever it suits you, and I am happy to wait for the right house.

With kind regards,

Claire Duval

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Note the last line. "I am happy to wait for the right house" does more work than any adjective in the email. It says you are not desperate, that you have standards, and that you understand this takes time. Consultants remember the candidates who are not in a hurry.

The follow-up, and then silence

Ten days later, once, and never again.

Dear Ms Lawrence,

A brief note, simply to remain visible to you. My situation is unchanged: available, fully mobile, and seeking the right private household rather than the next one.

I would be glad to be considered whenever something suitable comes to you, and I remain at your disposal.

With kind regards,
Claire Duval

What loses you a consultant, permanently

- Naming a former principal or family, at any point, in any medium.
- Applying to the same role through two different agencies. It will be discovered, and it ends both relationships.
- Chasing. Three emails in a fortnight tells them exactly how you will behave in a household.
- Declining an interview at short notice, or arriving unprepared. Their reputation is on the table, not yours.
- Negotiating a salary aggressively at the first stage. There is a moment for the number. It is not the beginning.
- A public social media presence that shows the life of a client, however innocently. This is the end of a career in this field.

The long game

The first role you are offered may not be the one you dreamed of. Take it if it is a good house, and be impeccable in it for two years. In private service, the second role is given by reputation, and the third is offered before you have asked. That is how this world truly works, and there is no way to skip it.